India's **first women's bank** is proposed to be set up with Rs. 1,000 crore as initial capital.

The government has finalised a number of proposals relating to the **insurance** sector in consultation with IRDA. These include empowering insurance companies to open branches in Tier II cities and below without prior approval of IRDA, having an office of LIC and a public general-insurance company in all towns with the population of 10,000, and permitting banks to act as insurance broker. The Rashtriya Swasthiya Bima Yojana, which cover 34 million families below the poverty line, will now be extended to other categories such as rickshaw, auto-rickshaw and taxidrivers, sanitation workers, rag pickers and mine workers. The Budget proposes to evolve a ***comprehensive social security package*** by converging various schemes for life-cum-disability cover, health cover, maternity assistance and pension benefits.

A number of proposals relating to capital market have been finalised in consultation with SEBI. These include simplification of procedure and uniform norms for foreign portfolio investors, clarity relating to FDI investment, allowing FIIs to participate in new areas, etc.

Budget Estimates

The total expenditure in the Union Budget 2013-14 is pegged at Rs. 16,65,297 crore. Out of it Rs.5,55,322 crore (33%) is Plan expenditure. The non-Plan expenditure is estimated at Rs 11,09,975 crore.

The Plan expenditure in 2013-14 will be 29.4 per cent more than the revised estimates of the current year. All flagship programmes have been fully and adequately funded. Juxtaposing economic welfare with the economic policy, the Minister said that the link between policy and welfare can be expressed in a few words: opportunities, education, skills, jobs and incomes. The Budget has before it one overarching goal to create opportunities for the youth to acquire education and skills that will get them decent jobs or self-employment that will bring them adequate incomes that will enable them to live with their families in a safe and secure environment. The Budget sets a target of skilling 90 lakh people in 2013-14,